LARKSPUR LANE VETERINARY CLINIC

Research Brief: Online Appointment Booking Tools

AI-ASSISTED SAMPLE

Prepared by Jennevie Javier · Prices checked October 7, 2026 · Fictional client

The question

Larkspur Lane is a small clinic (2 vets, 3 front desk staff) that books almost every appointment by phone. The owner asked: **which online booking tool should we try first, and what will it cost?**

> **Short answer:** start with **Square Appointments Free** for a 30-day test of online booking at no monthly cost. If clients use it and the team wants separate calendars per vet and a waitlist, move to **Square Plus ($29/month)**. Only look at a vet-specific system like **Vetstoria** (from about $199/month) if the clinic needs bookings to flow straight into its practice management software.

What the clinic needs

- Clients can book 24/7 without calling
- Automatic reminders to cut no-shows
- Separate schedules for each vet
- Low cost to start, nothing locked in for a year
- Simple enough for front desk staff to learn in a day

The four options compared

Tool	Price (USD)	Good for the clinic	Watch out for
Google Calendar appointment schedules	Free: one booking page. $9.99/month (Workspace Individual): premium features.	Staff already know Google Calendar. Free tier takes unlimited appointments. Premium adds reminders, payments and checking availability across calendars.	Built for one person's calendar. The free tier has only one booking page, so not one per vet.
Calendly	Standard $10 per staff seat/month; Teams $16 per seat/month (billed yearly).	Very easy for clients. Unlimited appointment types, reminders and automated follow-ups on Standard.	Price is per seat, so 5 staff on Teams is about $80/month. Not made for clinics (no pet or patient records).

Tool	Price (USD)	Good for the clinic	Watch out for
Square Appointments	Free (1 location); Plus $29/month; Premium $69/month, per location.	Free plan includes online booking, Google/Outlook sync, automatic reminders and payments. Plus adds staff calendars, waitlist and cancellation policies.	Card fees apply when taking payments (2.6% + 15¢ in person, 3.3% + 30¢ online). Not vet-specific.
Vetstoria	From about $199/month; price depends on team size and region (get a quote).	Built for vet practices. Connects to practice management software in real time. Used by over 4,500 vet teams.	The most expensive option. Worth it mainly when bookings need to land straight in the clinic's patient records.

Recommendation and next steps

1. **Weeks 1 to 4:** set up Square Appointments Free with three services ("Wellness exam", "Vaccines", "New patient exam"). Add the booking link to the website, Facebook page and email signature.
2. **Track two numbers:** how many bookings come in online, and how many no-shows there are compared with phone bookings.
3. **End of month:** if 15% or more of bookings arrive online, upgrade to Square Plus for per-vet calendars and the waitlist. If the clinic wants bookings synced with its patient records, request a Vetstoria demo and quote.

> **Before deciding:** prices change often, so confirm current pricing on each vendor's site on the day of purchase. All prices are in US dollars and exclude tax.

Sources

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- Cal.com, "Calendly pricing" (2026 plan breakdown): cal.com/blog/calendly-pricing
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- Capterra, "Vetstoria pricing and reviews": capterra.com/p/162603/Online-Booking/

AI-assisted sample by Jennevie Javier. Larkspur Lane Veterinary Clinic is fictional. Tool names and prices are real as of the date above.